

WEEK 3 OF 4 · Mind

Script 3: The Mental Reset (Mushin)**Theme: Letting Go of Mistakes**

Rationale: Mindfulness helps athletes let go of distraction and self-judgment. This script provides a visualization tool for the instant "mental reset" — the ability to wipe the board clean and return to the present.

Request that students find their meditation stance. Remind students of the "out."

"In a fight, if you get hit and you stop to think about how angry you are, you will get hit again. We need Mushin — a mind that flows and doesn't get stuck. We are going to practice the 'Mental Reset.'

Settle into your stance and find your breath. I want you to bring to mind a mistake you made recently. Maybe it was in school, at work, or on the mats. Notice the feeling that comes up. Maybe frustration, maybe embarrassment. Notice how your mind wants to replay it over and over. (Pause for 10 seconds.)

Now, imagine your mind is a whiteboard. That mistake is written on it in big letters. On your next exhale, I want you to imagine taking an eraser and wiping that board completely clean. White. Blank. Fresh. The mistake is gone. The only thing that exists is right now.

If the thought comes back, simply wipe the board clean again. Practice this 'wipe clean' motion with your breath for the next few moments. (Pause for 20 seconds.)

You are starting fresh with every breath. When you are ready, open your eyes."

MINDFULNESS ON THE MATS

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